



REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-01

NEW PRODUCT LAUNCH WEBSITE

TYPE: Growth**REQUIREMENT:** Marketing is launching a flagship product this quarter and needs a modern public website.**SATISFIED BY:** Web Server (7), OR web service hosted on a Cloud Workload (4)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-5 points** (launch flops; lost sales)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-02

CUSTOMER DATA ACQUISITION

TYPE: Growth / M&A**REQUIREMENT:** The executive team is acquiring a customer-data company. Two million customer records must land somewhere safe by end of quarter.**SATISFIED BY:** Database Server (10), OR database service hosted on a Cloud Workload (4) – cloud-hosting the crown jewels is a recorded risk**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-10 points** (deal falls through)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-03

WORK-FROM-HOME PROGRAM

TYPE: Workforce**REQUIREMENT:** HR is rolling out flexible work. Staff need secure remote access to internal systems.**SATISFIED BY:** VPN Gateway (9)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-3 points** (staff use risky workarounds; morale dips)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-04

REMOTE WORKFORCE MANDATE

TYPE: Workforce**REQUIREMENT:** The board mandates support for a fully remote workforce: secure access AND central identity for every remote login.**SATISFIED BY:** VPN Gateway (9) AND Domain Controller (12)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-5 points** (shadow IT spreads across home offices)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-05

HIPAA COMPLIANCE MANDATE

TYPE: Compliance**REQUIREMENT:** A new healthcare client puts you in HIPAA scope. Regulators expect recoverable data and isolated sensitive systems.**SATISFIED BY:** Backup Server (9) AND network segmentation (Network Segmentation Switch (10), or Segmented/Fully Isolated architecture)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-10 points** (client walks; compliance exposure)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-06

PCI SCOPE: CARDHOLDER DATA

TYPE: Compliance**REQUIREMENT:** You now process card payments. Cardholder data must live on a database that is walled off from the rest of the network.**SATISFIED BY:** Database Server (10) or cloud-hosted database, AND a Firewall (12) or Network Segmentation Switch (10) protecting it**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-10 points** (acquirer threatens to pull card processing)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-07

99.9% UPTIME SLA

TYPE: Operations**REQUIREMENT:** Your biggest customer signs a contract with a 99.9% uptime SLA on your public services. A single box is no longer good enough.**SATISFIED BY:** Load Balancer (8), OR a second server duplicating any business-critical service (full price)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-5 points** (SLA credits eat the margin)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-08

M&A: INTEGRATE ACQUIRED NETWORK

TYPE: Growth / M&A**REQUIREMENT:** The company you just bought needs its two core services absorbed into your infrastructure this quarter.**SATISFIED BY:** Two free capacity slots across your existing servers, OR deploy any new server this turn to host them (overloading is allowed at +1 Budget per extra service)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-10 points** (integration stalls; synergies evaporate)

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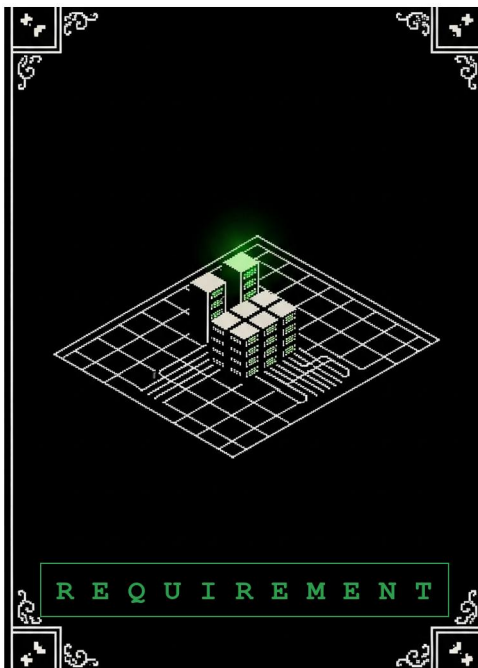
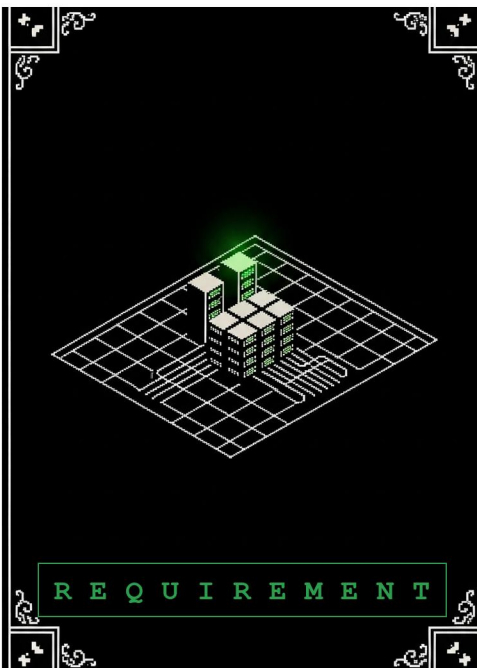
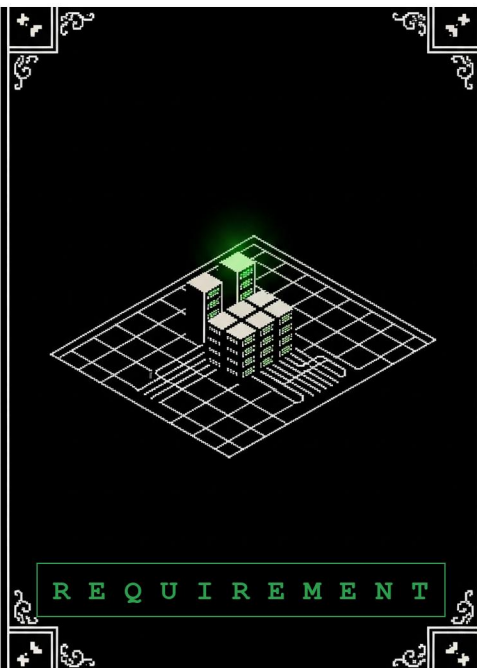
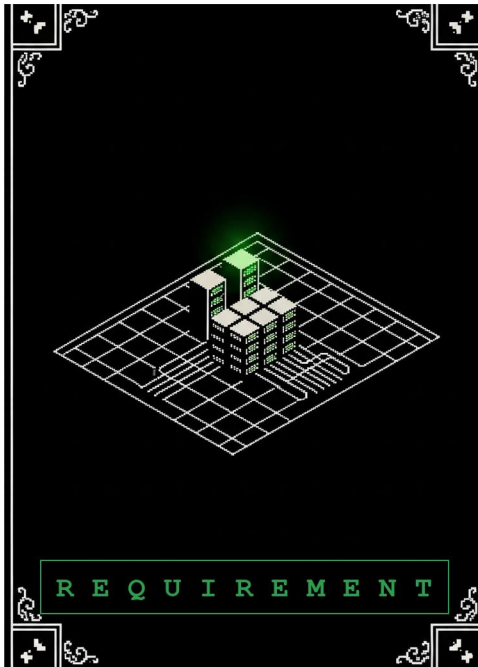
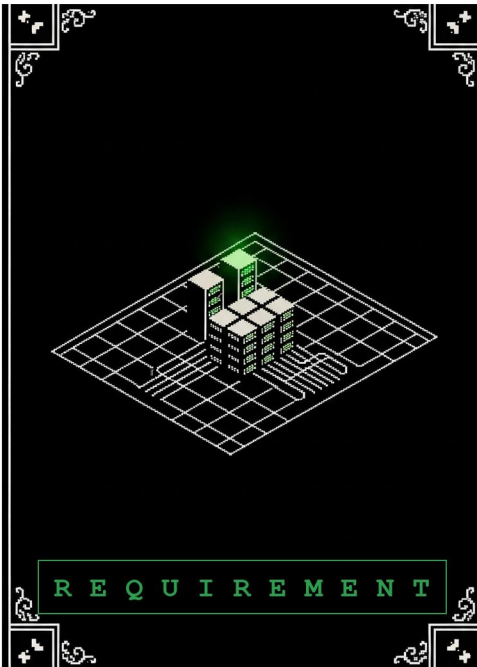
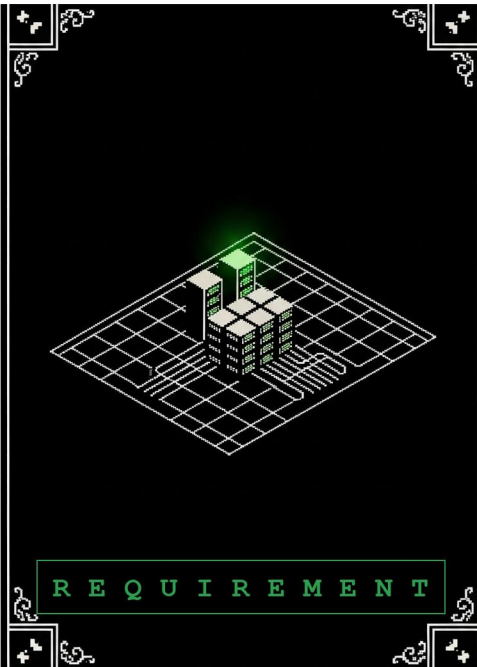
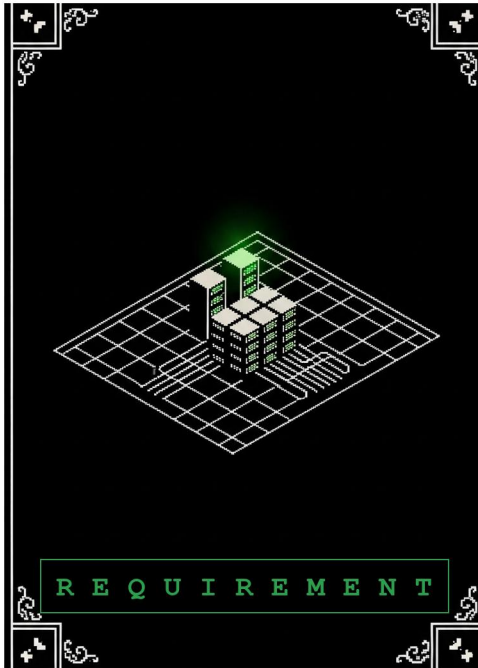
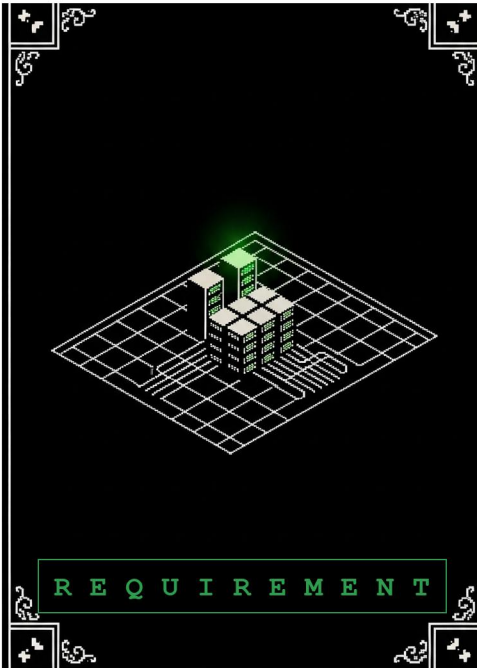
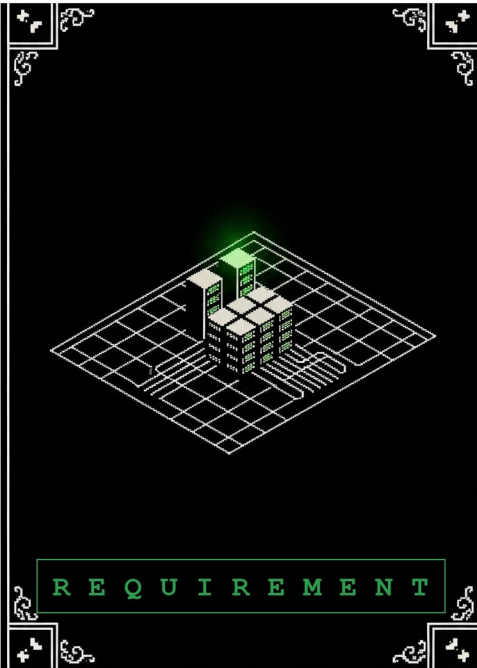
REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-09

SCALE EMAIL SYSTEM

TYPE: Operations**REQUIREMENT:** Headcount doubled and the email system is groaning. Add headroom.**SATISFIED BY:** Second Email Server (8), Load Balancer (8), OR email hosted on a Cloud Workload (4)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-5 points** (mail delays; missed customer requests)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-10

SECURITY AUDIT ORDERED**TYPE:** Compliance**REQUIREMENT:** The audit committee orders an independent security audit. Auditors expect centralized visibility of security events.**SATISFIED BY:** SIEM (15), OR both IDS (10) and Email Gateway (6)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-5 points** (qualified audit opinion)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-11

BOARD DEMANDS IR READINESS**TYPE:** Security**REQUIREMENT:** A competitor's breach is front-page news. The board demands demonstrable incident-detection capability.**SATISFIED BY:** IDS (10), IPS (14), OR SIEM (15)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-10 points** (board censure; CISO on thin ice)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-12

RANSOMWARE WAVE IN SECTOR**TYPE:** Security**REQUIREMENT:** A ransomware variant is tearing through your industry. You need recoverable backups AND a way to spot the attack.**SATISFIED BY:** Backup Server (9) AND at least one of IDS (10) / IPS (14) / SIEM (15)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-20 points** (you are one bad click from catastrophe)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-13

NEW SUBSIDIARY OFFICE**TYPE:** Growth**REQUIREMENT:** A new regional office opens with no local infrastructure. Staff there must reach head-office systems securely.**SATISFIED BY:** VPN Gateway (9)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-5 points** (office runs on personal email and USB sticks)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-14

E-COMMERCE EXPANSION**TYPE:** Growth**REQUIREMENT:** Sales moves online. You need a public web presence AND protection against the web attacks that come with taking payments.**SATISFIED BY:** Web Server (7) or cloud-hosted web, AND WAF (11)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-5 points** (checkout is either absent or a breachers waiting to happen)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-15

DEVELOPER HIRING SPREE**TYPE:** Workforce**REQUIREMENT:** Engineering triples in size. Developers need somewhere to build and test that is not production.**SATISFIED BY:** Development Server (5), OR dev services overloaded onto an existing server (+1 Budget per extra service – allowed)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-3 points** (developers test in production; incidents follow)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-16

RECORDS-RETENTION REGULATION**TYPE:** Compliance**REQUIREMENT:** New regulation requires seven-year retention of business records: durable shared storage plus a recoverable copy.**SATISFIED BY:** File storage (File Server (6), or hosted on another server's capacity/overload) AND Backup Server (9)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-5 points** (regulator issues a compliance notice)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-17

SINGLE SIGN-ON ROLLOUT**TYPE:** Operations**REQUIREMENT:** Password chaos across a dozen apps. Leadership wants one identity for everything.**SATISFIED BY:** Domain Controller (12)**SCORE IMPACT:** Missed: **-5 points** (password reuse everywhere; helpdesk drowning)

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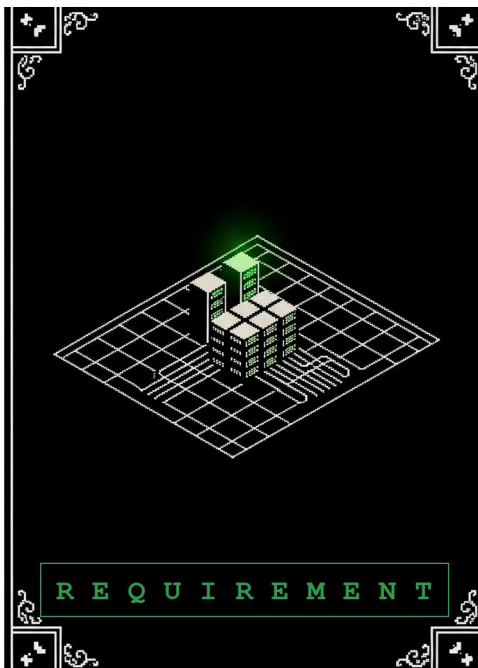
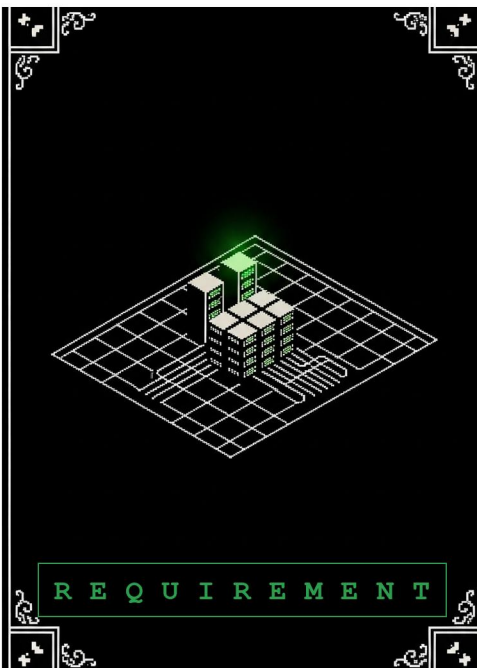
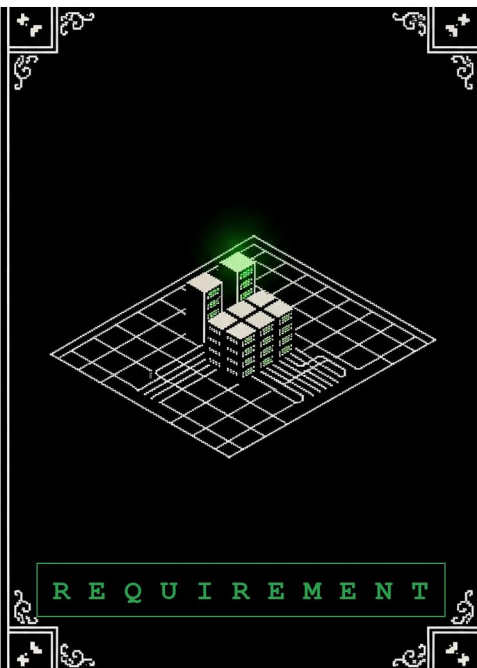
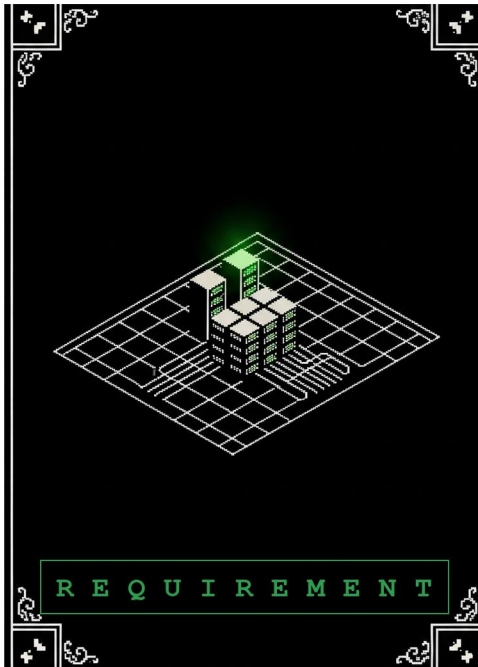
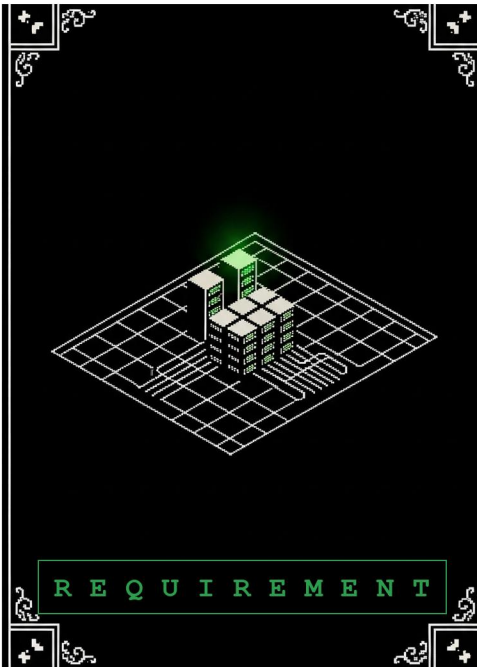
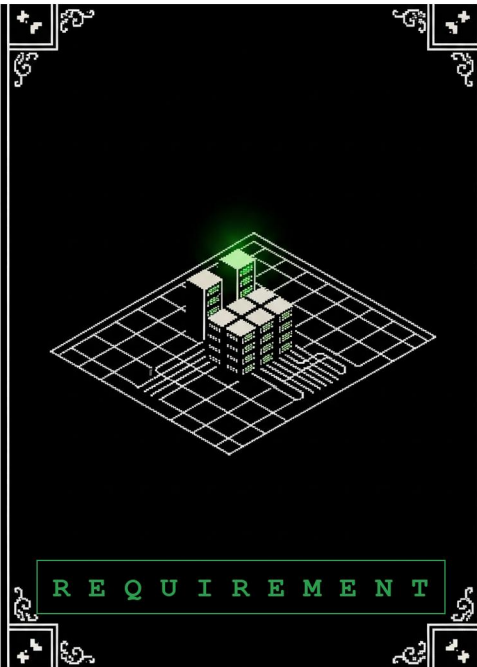
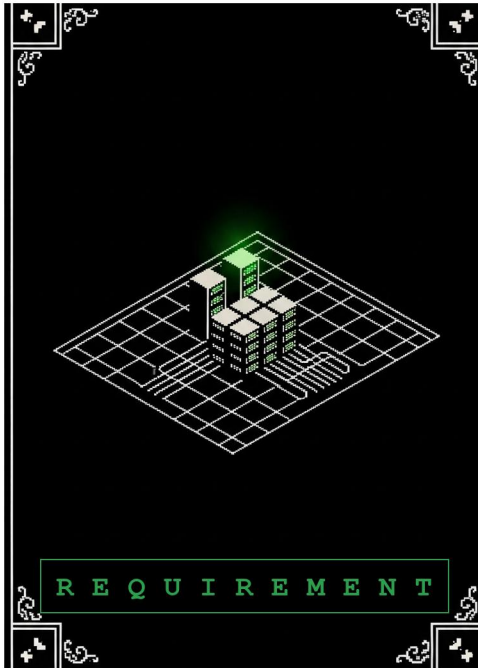
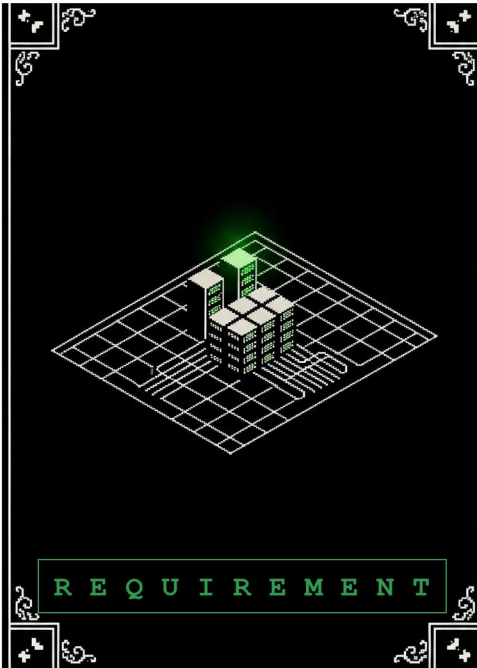
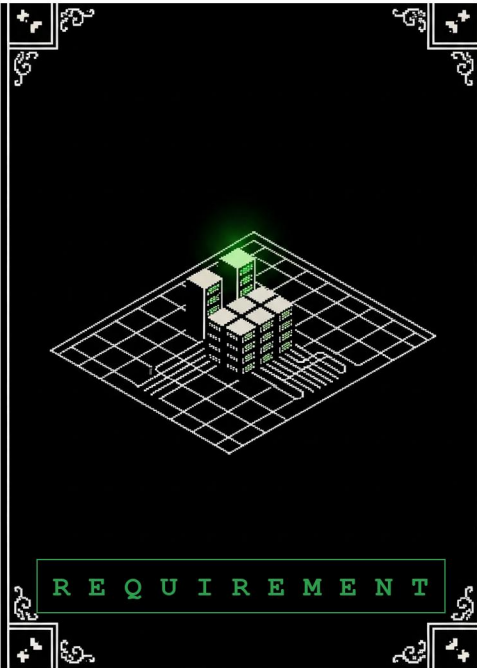


REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-18

CYBER-INSURANCE RENEWAL**TYPE:** Security**REQUIREMENT:** Your insurer's renewal questionnaire wants proof of backups, phishing defense, and detection.**SATISFIED BY:** Backup Server (9) AND Email Gateway (6) AND at least one of IDS/IPS/SIEM**SCORE IMPACT:** Met: **+5 points** (premium drops). Missed: **-5 points** (premium spikes)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-19

THREAT-INTEL PILOT

TYPE: Security (Opportunity)

REQUIREMENT: Your ISAC offers to feature any member running deception technology in its quarterly report.

SATISFIED BY: Honeypot Decoy (7) or Honeypot Network (8)

SCORE IMPACT: Met: ****+5 points**** (industry kudos). Missed: ****0 points**** (opportunity passes; no penalty)

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REQUIREMENT CARD

REQ-20

DATA-CENTER CONSOLIDATION

TYPE: Operations (Opportunity)

REQUIREMENT: Finance wants the server-room footprint shrunk. Show that at least one business service runs in the cloud.

SATISFIED BY: Any service hosted on a Cloud Workload (4)

SCORE IMPACT: Met: ****+3 points**** (opex savings). Missed: ****−3 points**** (facilities costs balloon)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-01

EMAIL SERVER FAILURE

TYPE: Outage

EFFECT: Your email server dies mid-quarter. Choose one:

MITIGATED BY: A second Email Server, or email hosted on a Cloud Workload – the redundant/cloud service carries the load: no cost, no penalty

– Repair: Pay 5 Budget (emergency callout) – Ignore: **−10 points** (email down all quarter; users furious)

No email service at all? Nothing to break – but you already have bigger problems (see Capability scoring)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-02

TRAFFIC SPIKE

TYPE: Load

EFFECT: Your product goes viral overnight. Public services are hammered.

MITIGATED BY: Load Balancer (8), CDN (expansion CLOUD-04), or redundant web hosting

– Prepared (Load Balancer, CDN, or a duplicated web service): **+5 points** (you rode the wave; sales boom) – Unprepared: **−5 points** (site down during your biggest day)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-03

PHISHING WAVE

TYPE: Attack

EFFECT: A targeted phishing campaign hits every inbox in the company.

MITIGATED BY: Email Gateway (6)

– Email Gateway deployed: **+5 points** (campaign filtered; nice catch) – No Email Gateway: **−10 points** (three credential sets stolen)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-04

CLOUD VENDOR OUTAGE

TYPE: Outage

EFFECT: Your cloud provider has a region-wide outage this quarter.

MITIGATED BY: On-prem redundancy for cloud-hosted services, or an all-on-prem design

LESSON: Cloud is cheap, but concentration risk is real

– If any required business service runs only in the cloud: **−5 points** (service dark; SLA breached) – Cloud services with an on-prem twin, or no cloud usage: no effect

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EVENT CARD

EVT-05

BUDGET CUT

TYPE: Finance

EFFECT: Fiscal crisis. ****Lose 5 Budget immediately**** (to a minimum of 0).

MITIGATED BY: Nothing – but teams holding a contingency reserve absorb it without changing plans

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EVENT CARD

EVT-06

EMERGENCY FUNDS

TYPE: Finance

EFFECT: A surprise rebate lands. ****Gain +10 Budget**** (one time).

MITIGATED BY: N/A (enjoy it)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-07

SECURITY GRANT

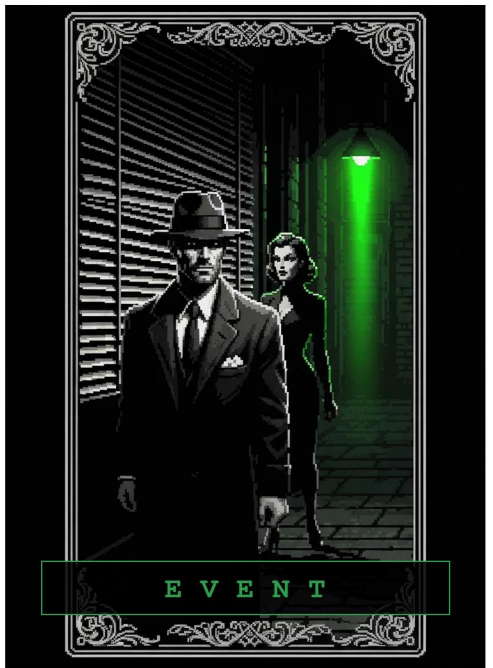
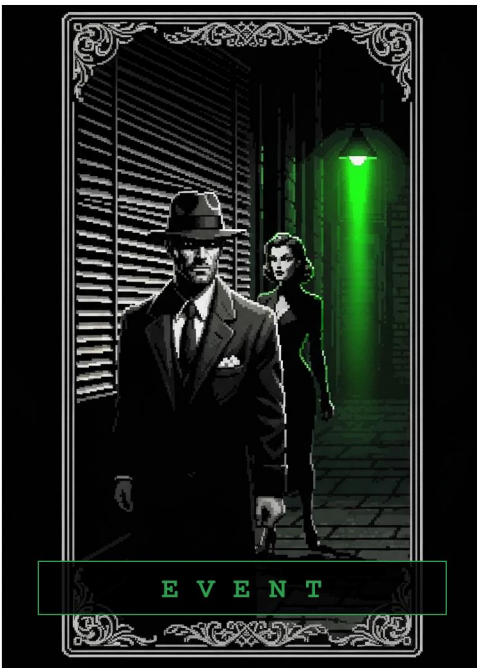
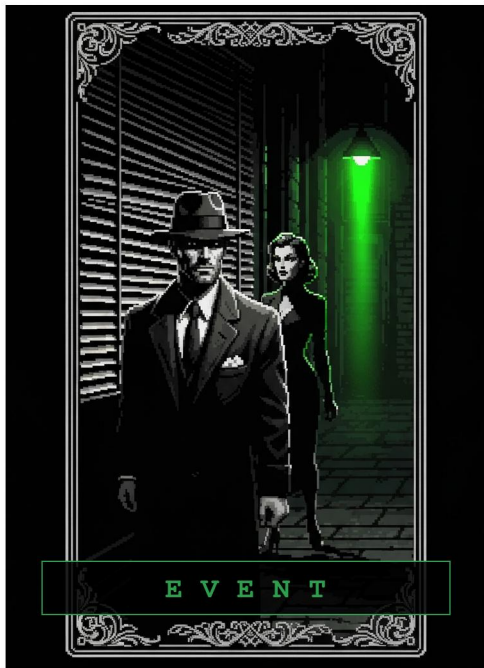
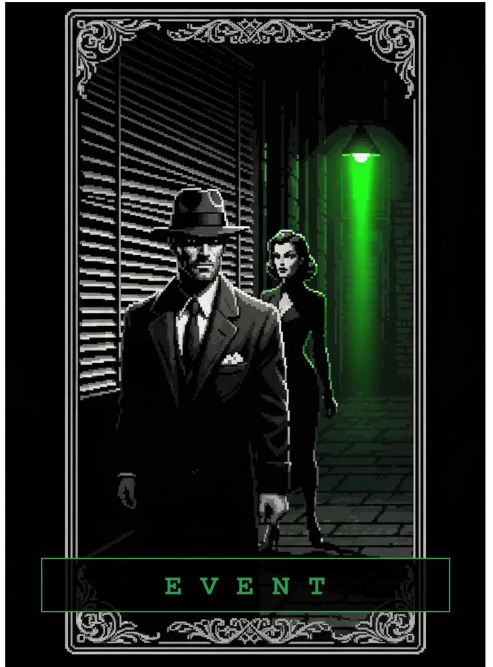
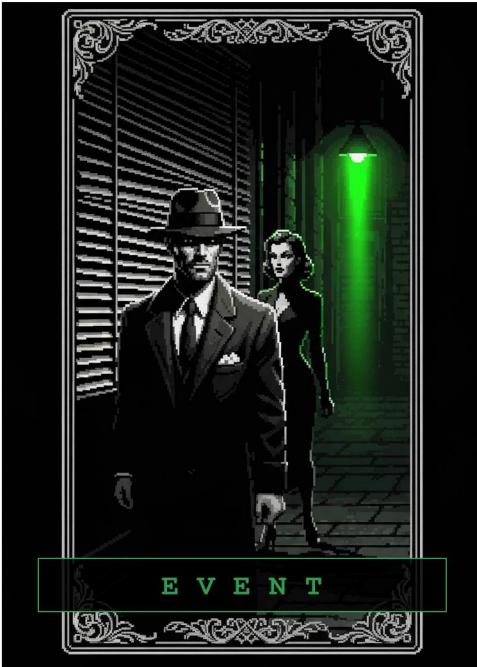
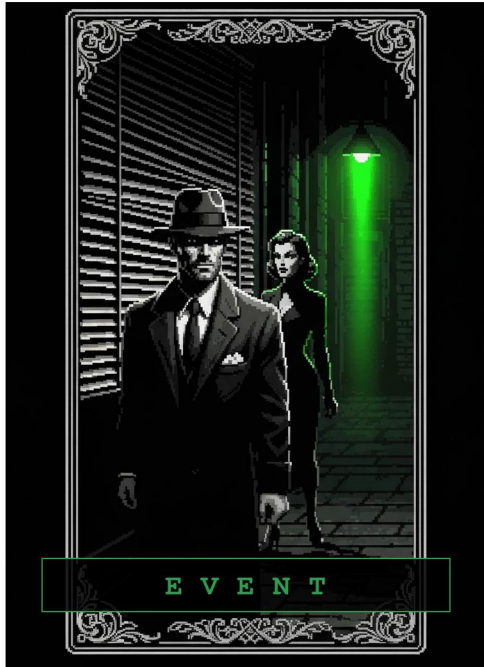
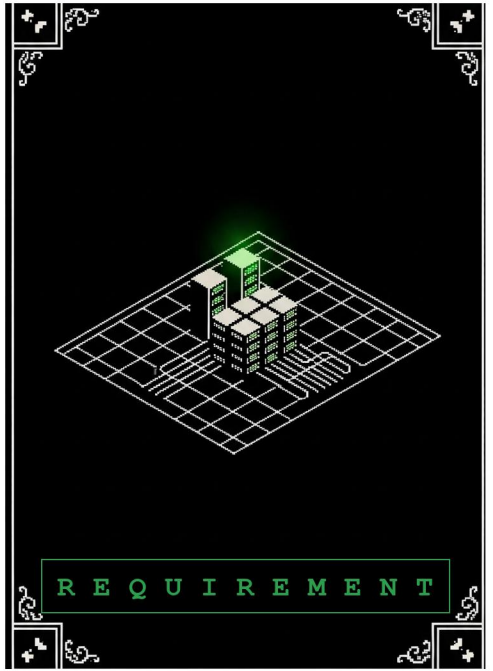
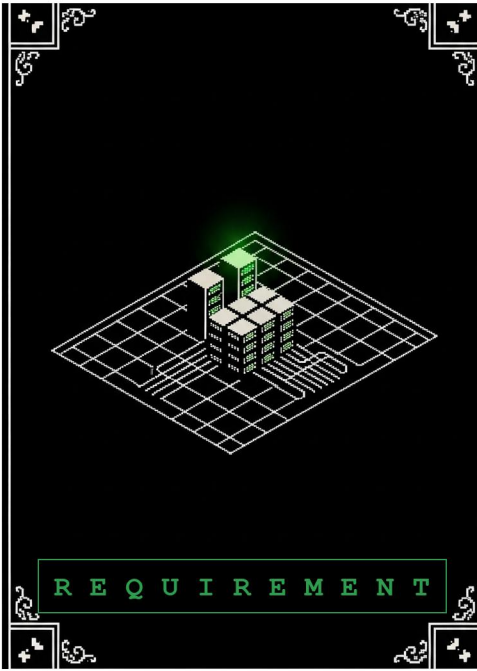
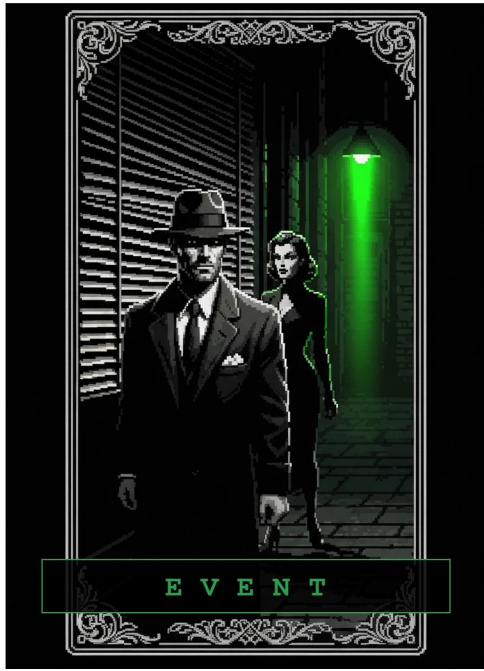
TYPE: Finance

EFFECT: A government cyber-resilience grant is available to organizations with recoverable backups.

MITIGATED BY: N/A – this one rewards good hygiene

– Backup Server deployed: **Gain +5 Budget**
– No Backup Server: **Nothing** (you don't qualify)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-08

FILE SERVER FILLING UP

TYPE: Capacity

EFFECT: Shared storage hits 98% full.
Choose one this turn:

MITIGATED BY: Spare capacity anywhere in
your design (assign file
storage to it at no cost)

– Add capacity: Deploy any server to host
file storage, or overload an existing
server (+1 Budget per extra service) –
Ignore: –5 points (service degradation;
work grinds)

No file storage service at all? No effect
– and no file-storage capability either

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EVENT CARD

EVT-09

HONEYPOT TRIGGERS

TYPE: Attack (Detected?)

EFFECT: Someone has been quietly probing
your network.

MITIGATED BY: N/A – this is deception's
payday

– Honeypot Decoy or Honeypot Network
deployed: +5 points (intruder caught
red-handed in the decoy; access cut) – No
honeypot: Nothing visible happens.
Nothing visible *ever* happens. (No
penalty – this time)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-10

INSIDER SNOOPING

TYPE: Attack

EFFECT: An employee is browsing systems
far outside their role.

MITIGATED BY: SIEM (15) or Network
Segmentation Switch (10) /
segmented architecture

– SIEM deployed OR network segmentation
in place: +5 points (caught early /
blocked at the zone boundary) – Neither:
–5 points (months of quiet data access
before anyone notices)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-11

RANSOMWARE STRIKES

TYPE: Attack (Severe)

EFFECT: Ransomware detonates on an
internal system.

MITIGATED BY: Backup Server (9); detection
reduces blast radius

– Backup Server deployed: Pay 3 Budget
for restore effort; if you also have
detection (IDS/IPS/SIEM), you contained
it fast: +5 points – No Backup Server:
–20 points (pay the ransom or lose the
data – either way it's ugly)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-12

IT STAFF BURNOUT

TYPE: Operations

EFFECT: The ops team is running on fumes.
**This turn you may deploy at most
ONE component.** (Handling the
turn's Business Requirement with
an already-deployed component is
fine.)

MITIGATED BY: Designs that are already
complete – teams who
front-loaded their build
barely notice

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EVENT CARD

EVT-13

VENDOR PROMOTION

TYPE: Opportunity

EFFECT: A security vendor is clearing
stock. **The next security device
you deploy this turn costs 2
less** (minimum cost 1).

MITIGATED BY: N/A – pure opportunity; skip
it if nothing on the list
fits your design

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EVENT CARD

EVT-14

NEW HIRE NEEDS REMOTE ACCESS

TYPE: Workforce

EFFECT: A key new hire works from another
city and starts Monday.

MITIGATED BY: VPN Gateway (9)

– VPN Gateway deployed: No effect
(onboarding is routine) – No VPN Gateway:
–3 points (they quit in week two, or
worse: they improvise)

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EVENT CARD

EVT-15

HARDWARE RECALL

TYPE: Outage

EFFECT: A vendor recalls a faulty
component. Pick one of your
on-prem servers (Threat
Orchestrator picks if you won't):

MITIGATED BY: Redundant servers or
cloud-hosted twins (the twin
covers the outage: no cost,
no penalty). All-cloud
designs are unaffected

– Pay 3 Budget for expedited replacement,
OR – That server is offline this quarter
– any requirement it alone satisfies
counts as unmet this turn

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EVENT CARD

EVT-16

QUIET QUARTER

TYPE: Respite

EFFECT: Nothing breaks. Nobody attacks.
Finance leaves you alone. Use the
breathing room to review your
gaps.

MITIGATED BY: N/A

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